



FLIGHT OF HOPE: Dalai Lama (centre) with bodyguards after fleeing Lhasa

ELSEWHERE...

- Soviet forces arrived in Afghanistan.
- The United Nations issued its Declaration of the Rights of the Child.
- US President Dwight Eisenhower signed a proclamation admitting Alaska to the Union as the 49th state.
- Fidel Castro (below) took over Cuba, leading



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revolutionaries to victory over Fulgencio Batista, who fled to the Dominican Republic.

- An agreement was signed by Britain, Turkey and Greece, granting Cyprus its independence.
- The Barbie Doll was unveiled at the American Toy Fair in New York priced at \$3.

"WE CAN'T WORK UNDER THE DEFENCE MINISTER."

General K.S. Thimayya

So said the war hero and Chief of Army Staff in a stand-off with Jawaharlal Nehru's dearest friend, V.K. Krishna Menon. The son of a coffee planter in Coorg, Thimayya was the closest to pacifist India's idea of a modern military hero, writes Ramachandra Guha. A veteran of World War II, he supervised the movement of refugees in Punjab, battled raiders in Kashmir and led a UN team to Korea. But when Defence Minister Menon appointed B.M. Kaul as lieutenant general in 1959, Thimayya quit. Nehru recalled him after two long sessions in his office and the lack of preparation for battling China, which so worried "Timmy", was never addressed.



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lakh Partition refugees were paid a total of Rs 128.3 crore as compensation. Millions of people had left their fixed assets and crossed the borders after the division of the country into two nations.